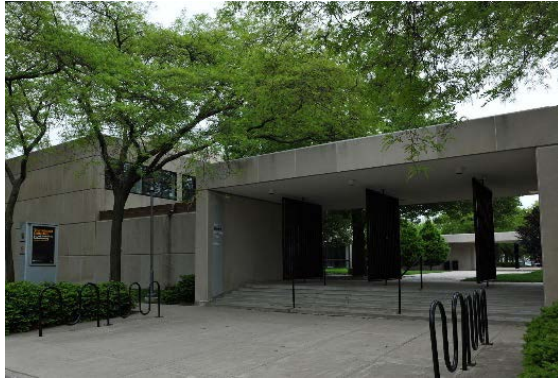


Smart Museum of Art & Cochrane-Woods Art Center C13 & C14



[If you have comments, send additional information](#)

Address: 5550 & 5540 S. Greenwood Avenue,
Chicago, IL 60637

Year Construction: 1974

Year Acquired: 1974

Architect: Edward Larrabee Barnes

Gross Square Feet: 42,474 & 14,018

Primary Use: Art museum and office/classroom
building.

Design Zone: North Campus

Last Major Renovation: 2011

Comments: The David and Alfred Smart Museum of Art is a three-level art museum on the campus of the University of Chicago. The Cochrane-Woods Art Center is an administrative and teaching art center on the campus of the University of Chicago. The facility is a two-story building consisting of administrative office space, classrooms, and lecture spaces. This museum and the Cochrane Woods Art Center flank each other and create a central open air courtyard.

REGULATORY STATUS

National Register: No

NR Comments: N/A

NR Historic District: Hyde Park-Kenwood

Landmark Status: None

Chicago HRS Color Code: None

CHRS Comments: None

1 - Site

Land Ownership Status: Owned

Location - Physical: North of 56th Street, East of Ellis Avenue.

Location - Program Adjacency: East is Henry Crown Field House. To the north is North Residence Hall. To the west is the Court Theatre and Henry Crown

Athletic Center. To the south are the Max Pelevsky Residence Halls.

Location Comment: The site around the facility is planted in a combination of grass, low growing shrubs, and ornamental trees. Between the two buildings is a courtyard with a sculpture garden.

In 1988 the Smart courtyard was named the Vera and A.D. Elden Sculpture Garden due to a gift from the Smart Family Foundation in honor of Vera Elden, a sister of David and Alfred Smart. In 2008 the garden was re-designed by UrbanLab and landscape architect Chandra Goldsmith. Features of the redesigned space include a five-foot high grassy hill and a patchwork quilt of indigenous plantings which provide a renewed environment for the display of sculpture and for visitor seating. Three sculptures which remain in the courtyard are: *Bench and Table* by Scott Burton; *Sky Sentinels* by Louise Nevelson; and *Truncated Pyramid* by Jene Highstein. The garden is also the location of wide variety of programming including musical performances and poetry readings.

2 - Adaptability

Construction Type: Reinforced concrete

Accessibility: Smart: Entrance - Y;
Bathrooms - P., Cochrane-Woods: Entrance - Y; Bathrooms - Y.

Floor-to-Floor Height:

Adaptability: No Comment

3 - Building Envelope

Roof Type: Multi-level flat

Exterior Facade: Limestone

Exterior Base: Limestone

Exterior Trim: Limestone

4 - Heritage and Historic

Heritage - Exterior: The Art Center was originally envisioned as a subsidiary complex in the southeast corner of the larger North Quadrangle Plan and as such related axially and formally to the rest of the site structures. The organizational *parti* of the Smart Museum/Cochrane-Woods Art Center is a symmetrically balanced composition with the primary axis of symmetry running north/south through the center of the complex. The original fully-realized building program for the site was to include a four-story art library and classroom building with an interior light well and a walled courtyard

similar in design to the existing sculpture court to the north of the library terminating in a theater building at East 55th Street. This plan was ultimately only extended executed in part.

The building facades are composed of uniform honed finish limestone veneer panels, rectangular and oriented vertically. The typical building panel dimension is 6 feet vertical by 4 feet horizontal throughout the entire complex. The overall appearance of the facades is a series of flush uniform planes with carefully detailed 45-degree chamfers at the horizontal edge with a similar sculpted chamfer at outside edges of abutting panels. The façade panels at the parapet are not differentiated by a visible coping. Windows are set flush into the limestone veneer with doorways set into deep recesses in the façade. Windows and doors are single or double glazed in dark bronze anodized frames set flush with adjacent limestone panels.

The large limestone gateways at the east and west entrances to the sculpture courtyard are composed of similar veneer panels which rise above the adjacent enclosure wall. Set into the gateway are large black painted steel gates on a single central pivot anchored at the base and head which allow for them to be closed and secured.

Heritage - Interior: The gallery has concrete masonry unit bearing walls running east-west allowing for a 56' uninterrupted north/south span. The classroom/office north wing is constructed of two bays with the first bay spanning 20'-8" from the south wall to the center of interior concrete columns and the second spanning 25'-8" to the north bearing wall. The classroom/office wing also has reinforced concrete floor and roof slabs (due to the original intention that this wing would eventually connect to the proposed art library and theater building, thus requiring a high load capacity for the library collection).

The Smart Museum interior finishes are minimal and substantially original. The gallery and lobby floors are white terrazzo with an integral terrazzo wall base, with divider strips in a 48"x48" grid in the gallery and a 62"x62" grid in the lobby. The walls are plaster or gypsum board with veneer plaster over plywood at the permanent partitions, with purpose-built demountable partitions being constructed by an outside contractor for specific exhibit requirements. The exhibit walls have no applied base. The gallery lighting, reconfigured during the 1999 renovation, consists of a regular grid of track lighting with repositionable light fixture heads.

Office and support spaces have acoustical tile lay-in ceilings with 1x4 recessed fluorescent light fixtures, painted gypsum board walls with resilient base, and resilient tile flooring. The first floor south-facing classrooms in the north wing have integral sliding blackout panels at the exterior wall in addition to horizontal blinds typical at perimeter windows. Storage rooms typically have painted concrete masonry unit walls with resilient or sealed concrete flooring and exposed ceiling construction with suspended fluorescent light fixtures.

Significant Spaces Identified: None

Heritage Culture Elements: None

Architectural Awards Certification: None

Heritage and History - General Comments:

The Faculty Advisory Committee on Student Residences and Facilities was convened in 1964 to assess current campus conditions as well as to make recommendations for future development as part of the Campaign for Chicago, a major university fundraising initiative. The committee report was issued in May of 1965.

The primary focus of the Committee was the lack of residential accommodation for undergraduate and graduate students as well as faculty. The Barnes Plan, later designated as the North Quadrangle Plan, contained a significant amount of student and faculty housing which was intended to supplement other residential development in the works at the time. In addition to new facilities for housing the plan also advocated for new amenities including a new athletic center, a theater, and an art museum and art center. From this came the Smart Museum and Cochrane-Woods Center.

The Center is named in honor of the family of the late Frank Henry Woods and his wife, the late Nelle Cochrane Woods, who endowed the Woods Charitable Fund. A major portion of the Cochrane-Woods Art Center will be the David and Alfred Smart Gallery, named in honor of the founders of Esquire Magazine. The David and Alfred Smart Gallery consists of 7,000 square feet of exhibit space for permanent collections and traveling exhibits, a conservation room, darkroom, storage area, a workshop and administrative offices. The Cochrane-Woods Art Center has classrooms, a 50-seat lecture hall and faculty studies.

The Smart Gallery founding director, Professor Edward A. Maser, secured these and other contributions as part of a systematic collection development program which he oversaw until his retirement in 1983 and which was subsequently administered and adapted by succeeding directors.

Acquisitions included the Max Epstein Archive, founded in 1936, consisting of prints, drawings, and photographs of art works (now located in the Regenstein Library), and the original furniture grouping from Frank Lloyd Wright's Frederick C. Robie House. Also acquired in 1967 were bronze elevator doors from the Chicago Stock Exchange building by Louis H. Sullivan (now installed in the main Smart Museum lobby) and architectural fragments from works by Dankmar Adler and George Grant Elmslie. The Samuel H. Kress Foundation in 1973 donated a collection of medieval, Renaissance, and baroque art which formed the core of the old-master collection. In the late 1960's, faculty member Father Harrie A. Vanderstappen proposed the creation of a study collection of Chinese and Japanese scroll paintings which were acquired with the assistance of Mr. and Mrs. Gaylord Donnelley and Mrs. Jeanette Shambaugh Stein.

The Department of Art History was housed in Goodspeed Hall until 1974, with part of the library and object collection located on the top floor of the adjacent Classics Building. Small collection exhibits were also located in Ida Noyes Hall and the gallery in the Midway Studios south of the main quad. The Bergman Gallery on the top floor of Cobb Hall (now the Renaissance Society gallery space) was also used for exhibits. The Smart Gallery became autonomous from the Department of Art History in 1983, and in the 1990's began to focus on public outreach including educational programs for local public schools, as well as increased collaboration with faculty and the University curriculum.

5 - Sustainability

Certifications: None

Window Last Replacement: N/A

Weather Stripping: None

R Value Roof/Wall: N/A

Systems: N/A

Deficiencies: N/A